P-P-200D
November 15, 1973
SUPERSEDING
FED. SPEC P-P-200B
November 15, 1960 and
Int. Fed. Spec. P-P-00200C(GSA-FSS)
August 25, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PEN CLEANER, LIQUID

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers liquid pen cleaner for removing dried waterproof drawing inks from non-absorbent surfaces.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and grade. The pen cleaner shall be of one type and one grade.

1.2.2 Sizes (quantities of pen cleaner). The pen cleaner shall be furnished in jars containing 2 or 6 fluid ounces of cleaner, as specified (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

GG-L-256 - Lettering Sets and Accessories.
TT-I-528 - Ink, Drawing, Waterproof, Black.
TT-I-531 - Ink, Drawing, Waterproof, Colored.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141 - Paint, Varnish, Lacquer, and Related Materials; Methods of Inspection, Sampling, and Testing.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The documents listed below form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Liquid pen cleaner shall be made of a combination of solvents, organic cleaning agents and mild alkalis in a water base. The liquid shall not contain any toxic or volatile substances (see 3.3 and 3.4).

3.2 Cleaning properties. When tested as described in 4.3.1, liquid pen cleaner shall completely remove dried waterproof ink from ruling, lettering or drawing pens after being immersed in the cleaner for not more than 8 hours and rinsed with clear water. Deposits of carbon and shellac from the dried ink on the pen must be completely removed. After cleaning pens no residue from the pen cleaner shall appear on parts of pen. Pen cleaner will naturally discolor after use, but it shall maintain cleaning effectiveness.

3.3 Toxicity. Under normal conditions of use, the liquid pen cleaner shall be non-irritating to the skin and shall contain no ingredients which are toxic. Each bidder shall submit with his bid a certificate including test results from a recognized laboratory acceptable to the procuring agency, showing compliance with the foregoing requirement.

3.4 Evaporation. Liquid pen cleaner shall not evaporate when tested as described in 4.3.2.

3.5 Flash point. Liquid pen cleaner shall have a flash point not less than 175° F. when tested as described in 4.3.3.

3.6 Alkalinity. The pH of liquid pen cleaner shall be not less than 10.0 nor more than 10.9 when tested as described in 4.3.4.

3.7 Corrosion. The pen cleaner shall have no corrosive effect on plastic, hard rubber, brass, chromium, copper, nickel and nickel-silver, carbon and stainless steel. (See 4.3.5.)

3.8 Directions. Directions for use shall be furnished with each jar.

3.9 Workmanship. Pen cleaner shall be clean and uniform and free of any defects which may impair its utility.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.1), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified

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herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the inspection requirements specified herein unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling and Inspection.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All liquid pen cleaner offered for delivery at one time shall be considered the lot for purposes of sampling for inspection and tests.

4.2.2 Visual inspection. Random samples of liquid pen cleaner shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105. Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall not exceed 2.5 percent defective.

4.2.3 Test samples. Random samples of liquid pen cleaner shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level L-1.

4.2.4 Inspection. Liquid pen cleaner taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements of this specification for liquid contents, defects of the container and closure, workmanship and any other requirements not requiring tests. If the number of defective containers of pen cleaner exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.3 Tests. Liquid pen cleaner taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested as described herein. Failure of any sample to pass all of the tests shall be considered cause for rejection of the lot represented by the sample.

4.3.1 Cleaning. The test shall be made at room temperature (73.4 ± 3.6°F.) using a lettering pen conforming to Federal Specification GG-L-256 equipped with a cleaner pin or needle. The ink shall be black or colored (any color) drawing ink conforming to Federal Specifications TT-I-528 and TT-I-531. The ink reservoir portion of the pen shall be filled with black ink and allowed to dry, without the needle being inserted, for not less than 24 hours or until the ink becomes thoroughly dry. Immerse the pen with the dried ink into the pen cleaner for a period not exceeding 8 hours. Then remove pen from cleaning liquid and rinse thoroughly with clear tap water pushing needle through pen to remove any residue. Pen shall be free of any ink residue and also free of all traces of the pen cleaner. Examine small parts and crevices of pen to insure pen in thoroughly clean. Repeat test using the same pen cleaner and a colored ink. (See 3.2.)

4.3.2 Evaporation. Mark the fill line of the jar of pen cleaner in the "as received" condition. Remove cap from jar and store sample at room temperature (73.4 ± 3.6°F) for 8 hours. Examine the jar after the storage period and if any loss is detected, the pen cleaner is considered to have evaporated, and failed the requirements. (See 3.4.)

4.3.3 Flash point (Closed Cup). Flash point shall be determined in accordance with test method 4294 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141.

4.3.4 Alkalinity (pH). Mix 1.0 gram of liquid pen cleaner in 100 milliliters of freshly boiled distilled water cooled to room temperature (73.4 ± 3.6°F). Determine the pH value of this solution or a portion of it, to the nearest 0.1 unit at 77°F. by means of a suitable pH meter which employs a glass electrode. No correction for sodium ion concentration shall be made. (See 3.6.)

4.3.5 Corrosion. Samples of drawing, ruling and lettering pens having surfaces of brass, chromium, copper, nickel and nickel-silver, carbon and stainless steel shall be immersed in the pen cleaner for 24 hours. The samples shall then be removed from the pen cleaner and rinsed with cold tap water. There shall be no visible etching or pitting of the test specimens.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in Section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level of 2.5 defects per hundred units.

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TABLE I. Classification of preparation for defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package (Jar). Jars shall be wide mouth type, with lined metal or plastic screw cap closure. When specified (see 6.2), each jar shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Twelve jars shall be intermediate packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. Boxes shall be provided with top and bottom pads. Full height half slotted partitions shall be used to provide an individual cell for each jar not in an individual box. Boxes shall be closed in accordance with the applicable specification and the appendix thereto.

5.1.3 Level C. Pen cleaner shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Intermediate packages shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c or V3s. Boxes shall be closed, strapped and waterproofed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Three intermediate packages shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Pen cleaner shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special markings required in the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123 and 5.3.3.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to any special markings required in the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and 5.3.3.

5.3.3 Unit and intermediate packages. Unless otherwise specified, unit and intermediate packages shall be marked with the Federal Stock Number, nomenclature and quantity and the name of manufacturer or contractor.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Liquid pen cleaner covered by this specification is used for removing dried waterproof drawing ink from pens and lettering instruments by soaking the soiled or ink encrusted articles in the liquid.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Unit quantity required (see 1.2.2).
c. Levels of packaging and packing, and any special marking (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

6.3 Military standards. Items procured under this specification for military use are to be limited to the variety shown on the applicable military standards. Personnel of the military departments are requested to refer to these documents for guidance.

6.4 Federal specifications do not include all types, grades, classes, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those types, grades, classes, etc., of items required to meet the needs of the Federal Government.

6.5 It is believed that this specification adequately described the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.6 Standard packaging (civil agencies). The standard packaging and packing for civil agencies shall be as specified in 5.1 and 5.2.2, respectively.

DOD COORDINATION HAS BEEN WAIVED.

User Interest	Preparing Activity
Army - GL	GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each

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